

Nick Soderstrom

Senior project manager & operations lead

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Chicago, IL · Remote worldwide

SUMMARY

Senior project manager and operations lead with 10+ years running projects for federal research institutions, major universities, large corporations, startups and nonprofits. I take ownership of the moving parts, projects, timelines, tools, people and processes, so leadership can stay focused on growth. Top Rated Plus on Upwork with a 100% Job Success Score across 257 contracts and 17,800+ billed hours, 300+ contracts overall; longest engagement exceeds 3,700 hours. Currently shipping iPhone apps and websites by directing AI models (Claude, Grok) from brief to production.

300+

Client contracts

17,800+

Hours billed

100%

Job success score

Top 1%

Top Rated Plus on Upwork

Since 2015

Full-time freelance

EXPERIENCE

Operations & Project Manager · Chief of Staff · Freelance, Upwork 2015 – Present
300+ completed contracts (257 on Upwork) spanning project management, systems and CRM setup, executive support, events and media, and web and app builds. Longest-running roles below.

Digital Coordinator · SPARC.science 2022 – 2026
Four years and 3,700+ hours supporting the SPARC Portal, an open neuroscience research platform.

Account Manager · OFFX · Office Experience Company 2024 – 2025
Managed client relationships and kept orders on track from placement through delivery.

Project Manager · Video Production · BARBRI 2023 – 2024
Tracked post-production on hundreds of video courses, managing timelines with professors and creatives.

Jr. Marketing Manager · Blackdove Art 2022 – 2024
Guided clients from first touch through the sales and onboarding journey for a digital art platform.

Project Manager · Symplicity 2018 – 2022
Coordinated with many colleges and internal groups to keep design projects on track for nearly four years.

Executive Assistant · Rippling 2019 – 2020
Scheduling and project coordination for multiple executives.

Restaurant Manager · Pizzeria Bebu 2017 – 2018
Opening-day team of a restaurant that went on to earn a Michelin Bib Gourmand.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Project & operations management

Scoping, timelines and milestones · Weekly reporting and async updates · Process design and documentation

CRM & automation

GoHighLevel, HubSpot, Salesforce, Zoho · Zapier and Power Automate · AI-assisted workflows and reporting

Events & media

Zoom, OBS and livestream production · Premiere Pro, After Effects, Final Cut · Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign

Systems & tools

Asana, ClickUp, Monday, Jira, Trello · Notion, Airtable, Confluence · Microsoft 365: Planner, Teams, SharePoint

Executive support

Inbox and calendar ownership · Hiring pipelines and onboarding · Vendor and customer follow-up

AI-directed builds, web & apps

Claude Code & Grok, prompt to production · Astro sites, SwiftUI apps, GitHub Pages · WordPress, Wix, Shopify updates

EDUCATION

DePaul University, Chicago, IL

Full contract history and client feedback available on Upwork. References on request.